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Product

Smart Saver is a personal finance app that helps you manage all your spending in one place. It offers flexible bookkeeping tools and supports automatic imports from linked apps, banks, and payment platforms such as Venmo and PayPal.

The app includes a built-in AI assistant that analyzes the user's financial data, delivering timely notifications and personalized advice upon request based on the user's spending habits. It also provides on-demand insights into potential risks or savings opportunities. In addition, Smart Saver features a daily feed with local news and discounts to help you stay financially aware and make smarter spending decisions.

Similar Existing Services

- **Banking Apps / Payment Apps**

  For users who primarily rely on a single bank or payment service (e.g., Bank of America, Chase, Venmo, PayPal), the apps provide detailed transaction records and statements in one place. However, their focus is on payments and transfers rather than financial management. While they allow users to track or download transaction histories, they typically offer little to no analysis, summaries, or spending advice. In addition, their tracking is often limited to the bank's own accounts or specific payment methods, such as only the debit or credit cards issued by that bank.

- **Budgeting Apps**

  Some users prefer apps designed specifically for financial or expense tracking, such as YNAB, Rocket Money, or more open-ended tools like Notion. These apps often allow users to connect external financial institutions, set goals, and view visual reports like charts and graphs. While they provide a clear overview of a user's financial situation and progress toward goals, they rarely go beyond basic reminders or alerts (e.g., approaching a budget limit). They generally do not provide deeper insights, personalized analysis, or proactive advice.

Why the Idea Isn’t Fully Available Yet

The concept of a finance app with AI-driven insights hasn’t been fully realized yet due to several challenges:

- **Privacy and Security Concerns**

  Financial data is among the most sensitive types of personal information. Many users are hesitant to allow an AI system to analyze their complete financial history, fearing risks of misuse or data breaches.

- **Trust Issues**

  Users may question whether the app’s recommendations are truly in their best interest. Since most products aim to generate revenue, users might worry that suggestions could be influenced by sponsors or affiliates, rather than being purely objective.

- **AI Accuracy and Relevance**

  Many savings opportunities (e.g., sales or discounts) are highly time-sensitive or come with specific conditions. For AI to be genuinely helpful, it must deliver accurate, timely, and personalized suggestions that match the user’s actual needs. If recommendations are irrelevant, unclear, or poorly timed, users may waste time, miss opportunities, or even end up spending more instead of saving.

Stakeholder Analysis – Smart Saver

Customers / Users: Individuals using the app — young professionals, students, families, budget-conscious people.

- **Values & Motivations:**
  - Have limited source of income and want to increase savings for a specific goal, so want to find ways to cut spending.
  - Want to track spending easily
  - Appreciate savings opportunities (discounts, deals, subscription optimization).
- **Expected Behavior:**
  - Link financial accounts and payment apps for all the spending records
  - Ask AI for specific spending suggest on how or if they should make the spending on like new phone, furniture to make to purchase option the best

Owners/Employees: Developers, AI Engineers, designers, data scientists, customer support, marketing staff.

- **Values & Motivations:**
  - Want to create applications that has positive impact on users' life
  - Work to create AI accurate, timely, and personalized suggestions that match the user's actual needs
  - Ensure the product users' privacy
- **Expected Behavior:**
  - Build and maintain the product with high quality and security standards.
  - Train the AI in terms of usefulness, also continuously feeding AI with latest information on discounts, sales, policies updates
  - Provide customer support and ensure a positive user experience

Investors: Venture capitalists, angel investors, or corporate partners.

- **Values & Motivations:**
  - ROI — want to see the product scale and capture market share.
  - Growth potential in fintech + AI sectors.
- **Expected Behavior:**
  - Provide funding and guidance.
  - Push for monetization strategies (e.g., premium tiers, affiliate deals).
  - Expect progress reports and transparent metrics.

Regulators: Financial authorities, Government Department for data privacy and consumer protection

- **Values & Motivations:**
  - Ensure user data is handled safely and legally.
  - Prevent unlawful practices in financial recommendations.
- **Expected Behavior:**
  - Audit or review compliance (data handling, AI transparency).
  - Impose penalties for breaches or unethical practices.
  - Influence product design through regulation (e.g., privacy-by-design requirements).

Partners: Banks & Payment Platforms, Retailers & Service Providers (Potential Partners)

- **Values & Motivations:**
  - Gain users who are likely to increase activities on their platform or services
  - Provide discounts, coupons, affiliate offers.
- **Expected Behavior:**
  - Collaborate via partnerships or affiliate models.

User Journey:Primary User (Customer)

Name: Alice, 27
Occupation: Marketing Specialist
Financial Habits: Uses Chase card for groceries, Venmo for splitting rent, PayPal for online shopping on Amazon, Temu, Ebay. Subscribes to Netflix, Spotify, and a gym.
Scenario: Alice has been using her Macbook Pro for many years, but the laptop is not functioning as well as a few years ago because of the old battery and the laggy system. She wants to find out what is the best option if she wants to get a new Macbook laptop.
Actions, Mindset, Emotions: She is not in a rush for the new computer since it still has the core functionality working. But since she is not usually paying attention to all the technology news, she has very little ideas about how much these products cost, when and how much savings can there be about the sales, and what models and conditions are best for her use. She wants overall spending advice since it is not a cheap spending.

Phase 1. Collecting(Any period of time/transactions, affecting the suggestions' quality)

During normal daily usage, the user's spending is already entered into the app. With this specific input about getting a new phone, the AI now gains more insights into the user's spending habits and the type of product the user is looking for. The AI might ask for additional information, such as location, in order to provide better answers in the end.

Phase 2. Analyzing(30 secs)

With all the data and the specific requirements, the AI begins analyzing and narrowing down categories for the user, such as financing options or discount opportunities. Users should be able to view some of the critical parts of this analysis to understand how certain suggestions are made. Common factors include general sales from different stores, sales tax in current and nearby states, typical used-laptop prices, and the price and availability of different models.

Phase 3. Suggesting(1 minute)

The user now sees final and specific suggestions that also incorporate the prompt and any extra requirements for this purchase. If the user is confused or dissatisfied with certain suggestions, they can interact with the AI to see the reasoning behind them. The final suggestion should be actionable based on the user's financial situation and payment habits, while offering the best purchase options considering time, price, insurance/maintenance, and the conditions of different models.

Phase 4. Reaching (~months)

If the user decides to choose a financing option or save up for the purchase, the AI will generate a specific target and create a timeline toward achieving it. This includes setting milestones (e.g., monthly savings goals), tracking progress in real time, and sending reminders or motivational updates.

The AI may also adjust recommendations along the way, such as suggesting ways to cut back on certain categories, highlighting seasonal discounts, or showing how small changes in spending habits can help the user reach the goal faster.

By providing clear progress tracking and timely nudges, the AI ensures the user stays engaged and feels supported throughout the saving or financing period, ultimately making the purchase more achievable and less stressful.

Values Tension:

- Neutrality vs. monetization. Users want unbiased recommendations. Investors or owners may prefer affiliate deals, sponsored suggestions, or promotions that generate revenue.
- User behavior vs. AI suggestion: Over-reliance on AI suggestions for all spending decisions, without providing sufficient context, can limit the user's growth in financial awareness and understanding.
- Personalization vs. Privacy: The AI provides better suggestions if it has more data about the user (location, spending habits, preferences). Users, however, highly value privacy and data security.